

LOWER BACK PAIN

TIPS & STRETCHES TO HELP YOU FEEL BETTER



Lower back pain is common and usually gets better with time and consistent care. Use these tips and stretches to support your recovery.



KEEP MOVING

Stay active and avoid long periods of sitting or lying down. Take short walks throughout the day.



STRETCH DAILY

Gentle stretching can reduce tension and improve flexibility. Do the stretches below 1–2 times per day.



USE HEAT OR ICE

Try ice for the first 24–48 hours, then switch to heat. Use for 15–20 minutes at a time.



MIND YOUR POSTURE

Sit with good posture, feet flat on the floor. Use lumbar support if needed.



LIFT SMART

Bend at your knees, not your waist. Avoid heavy lifting and twisting.



SLEEP WELL

Sleep on your side with a pillow between your knees or on your back with a pillow under your knees.



BE PATIENT & CONSISTENT

Recovery takes time. Small, consistent steps can make a big difference.

WHEN TO SEEK CARE

Seek medical attention if you experience:

- Numbness, tingling, or weakness in your legs
- Loss of bowel or bladder control
- Pain that gets worse or does not improve
- Fever, unexplained weight loss, or severe pain after an injury

GENTLE STRETCHES FOR LOWER BACK PAIN

1 CAT-COW



- Start on your hands and knees, wrists under shoulders, knees under hips.
- Inhale, arch your back and lift your head (Cow).
- Exhale, round your back and tuck your chin (Cat).
- Repeat 8–10 times.

2 KNEE TO CHEST



- Lie on your back with both knees bent.
- Gently pull one knee toward your chest.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Switch legs.
- Repeat 2–3 times each side.

3 CHILD'S POSE



- Kneel on the floor and sit back on your heels.
- Reach your arms forward and lower your chest toward the floor.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Repeat 2–3 times.

4 LOWER TRUNK ROTATION



- Lie on your back with knees bent.
- Slowly rotate your knees to one side, keeping shoulders on the floor.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Switch sides.
- Repeat 2–3 times each side.



Listen to your body. These stretches should not cause sharp pain. Stop if you feel increased pain and consult a healthcare provider.

IF YOUR SYMPTOMS PERSIST OR WORSEN, PLEASE FOLLOW UP WITH YOUR PROVIDER.

This handout is for educational purposes only and is not a substitute for professional medical advice. Always consult your healthcare provider with any questions or concerns.